



TIPS & TRICKS



Listing files in the order of their sizes

If you want to have a list of the files sorted on the basis of their size, you can use the following command.

It will list the files in decreasing order.

```
# ls -l | grep ^- | sort -nr -k 5 | more
```

If you need to do the same thing recursively, you could use the second command shown below.

```
# ls -lR | grep ^- | sort -nr -k 5 | more
```

—Sumedh Gajbhiye,
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Resetting weird terminals

If you've felt that your bash terminal is misbehaving—showing junk characters for the prompt and displaying non-ascii characters for whatever you type—the following commands should put things back on track.

Type the command shown below at the terminal and press *Enter*:

```
# reset
```

If that does not fix the issue, then try the following:

```
# stty sane
```

—Sudheer Divakaran,
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Recording and playing back the terminal session

Here is a simple tip to record and playback a terminal session. It is done by using the command *script* and *scriptplay*.

This comes very handy while making tutorials using the terminal.

To start recording of your terminal session, use the following command:

```
$ script -t 2> timing.log -a output.session
```

Then type in:

```
$ ls  
$ touch test  
.....  
$ exit
```

Here, the *script* command takes two files as the -arguments *timing.log* (which stores information on the time at which each command is run) and *output.session* (which stores the output of the commands).

Now, to playback the recorded session, use *scriptplay* as shown below.

```
$ scriptplay timing.log output.session
```



Note: *timing.log* and *output.session* can be shared with anyone who wants to replay a terminal session in his terminal.

—Abhishek Singh,
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Generate random numbers using the shell script

Sometimes when you are programming with the shell script, there may be a requirement to generate a random number to be used in the script.

Here is the code to get a 3-digit random number.

```
var=$((dd if=/dev/urandom count=1 2>/dev/null | cksum |  
cut -f1 -d" " | cut -c 3-5));
```

This will store the generated random number in the variable named as *var*.

—Arpan Chavda,
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